# First News

28 April 2026 | Tuesday

Intelligent Investing

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## GLOBAL & REGIONAL MARKETS

In the U.S., the Dow dipped slightly on Monday but the S&P 500 and Nasdaq powered to fresh record highs ahead of Big Tech earnings week.

Asian stocks climbed on Monday after reports that Iran offered the US a proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, lifting sentiment after stalled talks. The MSCI Asia Pacific rose up to 1.7% — its biggest gain since April 14. Taiwan's Taiex led regional gains at +3.23% as TSMC surged to a record. Japan's Nikkei 225 added 1.38% to close at a new all-time high of 60,537, with Fanuc soaring nearly 16% on strong earnings. South Korea's Kospi jumped 2.15% to a record 6,615. In contrast, Hong Kong's Hang Seng slipped 0.24% while China's CSI 300 was flat at 4,771. Australia's ASX 200 edged down 0.23%. The BOJ is expected to hold rates this week as policymakers assess the Iran war's economic fallout. The Korean won outperformed all Asian peers as the Kospi climbed to a record.

Oil surged as stalled Iran peace talks left the Strait of Hormuz nearly blocked, deepening supply fears — WTI gained 2.1% to just over $96.77/bbl while Brent closed near $102. Gold held firm as investors watched the escalating Hormuz uncertainty. Focus is now shifting to megacap tech earnings (Microsoft, Amazon, Alphabet, Meta, Apple) and the Fed's expected rate hold on Wednesday. India's central bank introduced tighter provisioning rules requiring banks to set aside more funds for future losses, aligning with global standards.

### Asia-Pacific & U.S. Equity Indices

| Index | 4/25/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Dow Jones** | 49,230 | 49,167 | -0.13% |
| **S&P 500** | 7,165 | 7,173 | 0.11% |
| **NASDAQ** | 24,837 | 24,887 | 0.20% |
| **PCOMP (PSEi)** | 5,943 | 5,901 | -0.71% |
| **Nikkei 225** | 59,716 | 60,537 | 1.36% |
| **SHCOMP** | 4,079 | 4,071 | -0.20% |
| **Hang Seng** | 25,874 | 25,812 | -0.24% |
| **KOSPI** | 6,476 | 6,615 | 2.10% |
| **SENSEX** | 77,143 | 76,664 | -0.62% |
| **TWSE** | 37,550 | 38,932 | 3.55% |
| **ASX 200** | 8,787 | 8,766 | -0.24% |
| **BURSA KLCI** | 1,718 | 1,720 | 0.12% |
| **JCI (Jakarta)** | 7,360 | 7,129 | -3.24% |
| **STI (Singapore)** | 4,930 | 4,923 | -0.14% |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| SET (Bangkok) | 956 | 952 | -0.42% |
| VNINDEX | 1,862 | 1,858 | -0.22% |

## Commodities

| Commodity | 4/25/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| WTI Crude ($/bbl) | 94.4 | 96.43 | 2.11% |
| Brent Crude ($/bbl) | 105.33 | 108.09 | 2.55% |
| Gold COMEX ($/oz) | 4741 | 4712 | -0.62% |
| Silver COMEX ($/oz) | 76.41 | 76.61 | 0.26% |
| Copper COMEX (¢/lb) | 602.7 | 609.15 | 1.06% |
| Nickel ($/MT) | 8.5305 | 8.5525 | 0.26% |
| Coal ($/MT) | 130.5 | 129.8 | -0.54% |
| Corn (¢/bu) | 465 | 467 | 0.43% |
| Wheat (¢/bu) | 622 | 625 | 0.48% |
| Cocoa ($/MT) | 3440 | 3465 | 0.72% |
| Sugar (¢/lb) | 13.95 | 14.02 | 0.50% |

## FX & Fixed Income

| | 4/24/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| PHL 10yr Bond (%) | 6.71 | 6.794 | 1.24% |
| US 10yr Bond (%) | 4.31 | 4.339 | 0.67% |
| USD-PHP | 60.7 | 60.73 | 0.05% |
| USD-JPY | 159.33 | 159.36 | 0.02% |
| EUR-USD | 1.1726 | 1.172 | -0.05% |

## PSE MARKET SUMMARY — Monday, April 27, 2026

The PSEi fell 0.71% to close at 5,901.15, down 42.34 points, as conglomerates, banks, and property declined. Mining/Oils and Industrials bucked the trend with modest gains. The index traded in a range of 5,898–5,945. Value traded reached ₱5.35 billion. Market breadth was negative: 86 advances vs. 107 declines and 56 unchanged.

Net Foreign Selling: $11.151M. Net Foreign Buying April -$227.387M Net Foreign Buying YTD -$46.962M
Foreign Buying: ₱2,704,823,126. Foreign Selling: ₱3,382,167,314. Net Foreign Selling: ₱677,344,188. Total Foreign: ₱6,086,990,440.

## Share Buyback Transaction OPM MEGA SMPH

52 Week High – bncom ew mer pse
52 Week Low – abs ali apc bdo bpi chp cts eei keepr pbb phn pizza sun

RSI 70 Overbought – phr ew upm bncom
RSI 30 Oversold – abs gma7 keepr bpi

FOREIGN FUNDS SOLD bdo bpi cbc acen fgen mynld scc shlph cnpf dnl emi gsmi jfc keepr phn imi ac agi cosco dmc gtcap jgs ltg sm smc ali areit cpg creit dd fli geri meg mrc rcr smph dito tel ict bloom plus web wlcon apx ogp pxp

FOREIGN FUNDS BOUGHT ew mbt pnb secb dhi pse slf ap mer mwc sgp spc spnec monde pizza urc aev rock shng glo cnvrg ceb mac pgold rrhi at nikl px

## Top 10 Most Active Index Stocks

### PSEi Index

| Stock | Close | Value |
|---|---|---|
| **BDO** | 112 | ₱1.018B |
| **BPI** | 90.50 | ₱491M |
| **ICT** | 712 | ₱344M |
| **DITO** | 0.06 | ₱220M |
| **WEB** | 11.32 | ₱170M |
| **CNPF** | 31.50 | ₱162M |
| **ALI** | 15.80 | ₱160M |
| **MBT** | 68.50 | ₱144M |
| **MER** | 655 | ₱121M |
| **NIKL** | 4.98 | ₱106M |

## PSEi Component Stocks

| PSEi Stock | 4/24/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| AC | 490 | 473.00 | -3.47% |
| ACEN | 2.81 | 2.74 | -2.49% |
| AEV | 28.5 | 28.45 | -0.18% |
| ALI | 16.1 | 15.80 | -1.86% |
| AREIT | 39.8 | 39.80 | 0.00% |
| BDO | 115 | 112.00 | -2.61% |
| BPI | 92.1 | 90.50 | -1.74% |
| CBC | 63.95 | 63.80 | -0.23% |
| CNPF | 31.5 | 31.50 | 0.00% |
| CNVRG | 12.5 | 12.70 | 1.60% |
| DMC | 9.9 | 9.99 | 0.91% |
| EMI | 15.28 | 15.24 | -0.26% |
| GLO | 1648 | 1,639.00 | -0.55% |
| GTCAP | 492 | 497.00 | 1.02% |
| ICT | 700 | 712.00 | 1.71% |
| JFC | 162.8 | 161.00 | -1.11% |
| JGS | 27.1 | 27.35 | 0.92% |
| LTG | 14.9 | 15.00 | 0.67% |
| MBT | 67.5 | 68.50 | 1.48% |
| MER | 641 | 655.00 | 2.18% |
| MONDE | 6.68 | 6.72 | 0.60% |
| PGOLD | 42.5 | 42.95 | 1.06% |
| PLUS | 14.8 | 14.18 | -4.19% |
| RCR | 6.85 | 6.90 | 0.73% |
| SCC | 30.65 | 29.50 | -3.75% |
| SM | 624 | 613.50 | -1.68% |
| SMC | 71.5 | 70.70 | -1.12% |
| SMPH | 20 | 19.60 | -2.00% |

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|---|---|---|---|
| TEL | 1278 | 1,277.00 | -0.63% |
| URC | 61.5 | 62.30 | +0.81% |

## NEWS, ANALYSIS & INVESTING INSIGHT

**SCC — Semirara Mining & Power Corp.** **₱29.50** **MONITOR**

SCC plunged 3.75% on Monday to ₱29.50 as market uncertainty intensified around its coal operating contract, which expires in 2027. The government has indicated it will rebid the contract rather than grant an automatic extension. While SCC remains favored to win, markets are pricing in execution risk and regulatory uncertainty. Energy Chief Sharon Garin also confirmed the coal moratorium stays despite pressure for cheaper power amid Middle East tensions, with “very special exemptions” only for off-grid islands. (Source: PSE DQR, DA Market Securities, DOE)
Analysis: The rebidding overhang creates a binary risk event for SCC’s earnings visibility. The coal moratorium confirmation is a long-term structural headwind for new coal capacity but does not directly impact SCC’s existing operations. At ₱29.50, the stock is pricing in meaningful contract risk. Upside catalyst: contract renewal clarity. Downside risk: adverse rebidding outcome.

**Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Contract rebidding uncertainty dominates. Avoid adding until renewal path becomes clearer. Watch for government signals on timeline and terms.**

**MACRO — Philippine T-Bill Auction — April 27** **PHP 37.646B** **MACRO UPDATE**

The Philippine government raised ₱37.646 billion from its latest T-bill auction, surpassing the initial ₱36-billion target — a signal of continued investor appetite for sovereign paper despite the BSP tightening cycle. 364-day T-bills settled at 5.184%, 182-day at 4.737%, and 91-day at 4.558%. The upward trajectory in short-term yields reflects the market’s expectation of further BSP rate hikes through mid-2026.
Analysis: The oversubscription signals that fixed-income investors are positioning for a higher-rate environment and locking in yields ahead of expected June and August BSP hikes. The 5.184% one-year rate provides a useful benchmark for equity risk premium calculations: at current PSEi levels, the equity-over-T-bill premium is compressing, favoring high-yield defensive plays.

**GEOPOLITICS — Iran Hormuz Proposal via Pakistan** **—** **CATALYST WATCH**

Iran has submitted a proposal to the US through Pakistani mediators aimed at reopening the Strait of Hormuz and ending the ongoing war. The offer reportedly defers nuclear negotiations until the US blockade is lifted, while calling for an extended ceasefire to support progress toward a lasting settlement. This triggered the MSCI Asia Pacific’s biggest single-day gain since April 14 and led to Brent crude pulling back from intraday highs. (Source: Axios, Bloomberg, April 27)
Analysis: If the Hormuz proposal gains traction, the implications for Philippine markets are profoundly positive: lower oil prices would ease inflation, reduce BSP tightening pressure, strengthen the peso, and lift rate-sensitive sectors. However, the proposal remains unconfirmed by the US, and Trump scrapped plans to send envoys — suggesting diplomatic momentum is fragile at best. Trade the headline with caution; position for the possibility but don’t bet the portfolio.

**Stance: 🟢 CATALYST WATCH — Any confirmed Hormuz reopening is the single most bullish catalyst for Philippine equities in 2026. Monitor closely.**

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| **GLOBAL — BOJ Rate Decision — This Week** | — | MONITOR |

The Bank of Japan is widely expected to hold rates steady this week as policymakers assess the economic fallout from the Middle East conflict. The yen remains under pressure near 159.5/$ as the rate differential with the US persists. The Nikkei's record run to 60,537 reflects tech/AI optimism offsetting macro concerns.

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| **AEV — Aboitiz InfraCapital — Capex Raised to ₱8.8B** | **₱28.85** | ACCUMULATE |

Aboitiz InfraCapital (AIC), the infrastructure arm of AEV, is raising its 2026 capex to ₱8.8 billion from ₱4.1 billion in 2025 — more than doubling spending to fund expansion across airports, water systems, and Unity Digital Infrastructure (telecom towers). AIC CEO Cosette Canilao confirmed the increase at AEV's annual stockholders' meeting. At the group level, AEV has earmarked ₱88.5 billion in total capex for 2026, with ₱62 billion going to AboitizPower for RE and BESS expansion, and the balance supporting food, banking, real estate, and infrastructure. The GIP (Global Infrastructure Partners) strategic partnership, involving a 40% stake in AIC, is expected to leverage GIP's $183B global infrastructure network. AEV closed at ₱28.85 on Monday, up 1.2%. (Source: BusinessWorld, Manila Tribune, Context.ph, April 27–28)

**Stance: 🟢 ACCUMULATE — AEV's counter-cyclical capex ramp and GIP partnership signal long-term confidence. Infrastructure and RE-heavy mix is well-positioned for the energy transition.**

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| **CEB — Cebu Air / Cebu Pacific** | **₱33.00** | MONITOR |

Cebu Pacific CEO Michael Szücs said the airline hopes for fuel price easing by Q3 but is reviewing its 30-million passenger growth target for 2026. Q1 passenger traffic rose 8.4% to 7.54 million, but the Iran war has "severely impacted" fuel availability and prices. Fuel surcharges are at Level 19 (highest since 2022). CEB has secured jet fuel supply through June and is adjusting network operations, including Dubai route suspension to end-May and five international route suspensions to October. FY2025 net income more than doubled to ₱12.3 billion. CEB closed at ₱33.00 on Monday, up 1.85%. (Source: BusinessWorld, Inquirer, April 28)

**Stance: 🟡 MONITOR — Strong FY2025 base and 80% domestic flight mix provide resilience, but fuel cost trajectory is the key swing factor. Watch for Q3 fuel normalization signal.**

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| **BLC — Belle Corp. — Q1 Net Income +13%** | **₱1.28** |

Belle Corp. posted a 13% increase in Q1 consolidated net income to ₱524 million, driven by stronger gaming and real estate revenues. Total revenues rose 9% to ₱1.42 billion. Gaming revenue through Premium Leisure Corp. (City of Dreams Manila) grew 12% to ₱486 million; Tagaytay Highlands real estate revenues surged 57% to ₱143 million. Lease income from City of Dreams Manila was stable at ₱588 million. Belle closed at ₱1.28 on Monday. (Source: Philstar, Manila Times, Context.ph, April 28)

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| **MER — Meralco — Bill Charge Clarification** | **₱643** | ACCUMULATE |

Meralco moved to address social media misinformation about electricity bill charges, clarifying that all line items are regulator-approved and legally mandated. VP Joe Zaldarriaga emphasized that 55% of

the bill is generation charges (pass-through), 17.5% is distribution (Meralco's only revenue component), 11.7% taxes, 10.1% transmission, and 5.7% other mandated charges. Meralco's distribution charge has been unchanged since August 2022. April rates rose ₱0.53/kWh (~₱106 per household at 200 kWh), driven by generation cost increases and peso weakness. The oil crisis impact has yet to be fully reflected in rates — May bills may see further increases. (Source: BusinessWorld, GMA News, Power Philippines, April 27–28)

**Stance: 🟢 ACCUMULATE — Defensive utility with regulated revenue; distribution charge is locked. Oil crisis pass-through to consumers is a demand risk but not an MER earnings risk.**

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| **DHI — Dominion Holdings (Tampakan Speculation)** | — | **SPECULATIVE** |

Dominion Holdings clarified it has no approved plans for investment in the Tampakan copper-gold project, despite intense market speculation since the Sy-linked Monte Sur Equity Holdings takeover. DHI confirmed its intent to remain a holding company focused on mining investments, but "as of now, there are no definitive plans for investments or acquisition of interest." The Tampakan project, Southeast Asia's largest untapped copper-gold deposit, is privately held by the Sy, Alcantara, and Consunji families. Sid Consunji (chairman of DMCI and SCC) replaced DyBuncio as DHI chairman. (Source: BusinessWorld, InsiderPH, Bilyonaryo, April 28)

**Stance: 🟡 SPECULATIVE — Pure speculation play. No confirmed asset injection timeline. Monitor for PSE disclosures only.**

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| **AC — AC Mobility — ChargePlus Launch** | **₱488** | **MONITOR** |

ACMobility, Ayala's mobility arm, launched ChargePlus — a rebranded EV charging membership with no-expiry credits, tiered discounts, and lifestyle perks including BYD accessories, Bosch service vouchers, and Kia maintenance discounts. EV penetration has surged to 20–23% of new vehicle sales in March–April (from 12% in 2025), with BYD search volume up nearly 200% from February to March. ACMobility holds an 80% market share within the EV segment and expects profitability in 2026. The oil crisis is accelerating consumer switching to EVs. (Source: BusinessWorld, GMA News, CarGuide, April 25–28)

**Stance: 🟡 MONITOR (AC) — ACMobility's EV leadership is a structural bright spot within the Ayala conglomerate, partially offsetting real estate headwinds. Watch for profitability confirmation.**

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| **ENERGY — DOE Coal Moratorium Stays** | — | **SECTOR NOTE** |

Energy Chief Sharon Garin confirmed the coal moratorium remains in effect despite pressure for cheaper power amid Middle East tensions. The DOE says enough coal permits are already in the pipeline, with "very special exemptions" only for off-grid islands. This reinforces the structural headwind for new coal capacity while existing operators (SCC, SMGP, AboitizPower) continue under current contracts.

**Stance: 🔴 SECTOR HEADWIND — Long-term structural negative for new coal; existing operators are grandfathered but face rebidding risk (see SCC card).**

# PSE Dividend Yield Index (PSE DivY)

| PSE DivY Stock | 4/24/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| AREIT | 39.8 | 39.80 | 0.00% |
| CBC | 63.95 | 63.80 | -0.23% |
| CREIT | 3.45 | 3.52 | 2.03% |
| DMC | 9.9 | 9.99 | 0.91% |
| DNL | 3.56 | 3.53 | -0.84% |
| GLO | 1648 | 1,639.00 | -0.55% |
| LTG | 14.9 | 15.00 | 0.67% |
| MBT | 67.5 | 68.50 | 1.48% |
| MER | 641 | 655.00 | 2.18% |
| MREIT | 13.8 | 13.94 | 1.01% |
| NIKL | 4.85 | 4.98 | 2.68% |
| OGP | 34.3 | 34.15 | -0.44% |
| PGOLD | 42.5 | 42.95 | 1.06% |
| RCR | 6.85 | 6.90 | 0.73% |
| RLC | 17.6 | 17.70 | 0.57% |
| RRHI | 46.2 | 46.30 | 0.22% |
| SCC | 30.65 | 29.50 | -3.75% |
| SGP | 22 | 22.45 | 2.05% |
| TEL | 1278 | 1,277.00 | -0.08% |
| URC | 61.5 | 62.30 | 1.30% |

## PSE MidCap Index

| PSE MidCap Stock | 4/24/2026 | 4/27/2026 | %Chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| **AGI** | 8.9 | 8.95 | 0.56% |
| **APX** | 17 | 17.12 | 0.71% |
| **AUB** | 42.2 | 42.30 | 0.24% |
| **BLOOM** | 2 | 2.03 | 1.50% |
| **COSCO** | 6.65 | 6.71 | 0.90% |
| **DNL** | 3.56 | 3.53 | -0.84% |
| **GSMI** | 273.4 | 272.00 | -0.51% |
| **KEEPR** | 1.9 | 1.87 | -1.58% |
| **MEG** | 2.08 | 2.05 | -1.44% |
| **MREIT** | 13.8 | 13.94 | 1.01% |
| **MWC** | 42.8 | 43.30 | 1.17% |
| **NIKL** | 4.85 | 4.98 | 2.68% |
| **OGP** | 34.3 | 34.15 | -0.44% |
| **PNB** | 59.55 | 59.45 | -0.17% |
| **RLC** | 17.6 | 17.70 | 0.57% |
| **RRHI** | 46.2 | 46.30 | 0.22% |
| **SECB** | 65.95 | 65.15 | -1.21% |
| **SEVN** | 33.8 | 33.40 | -1.18% |
| **SGP** | 22 | 22.45 | 2.05% |
| **WLCON** | 6.25 | 6.25 | 0.00% |

🟢 **ACCUMULATE** 🟡 **MONITOR** 🔴 **AVOID** GOVERN = Governance Watch

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